

Macroderma gigas

Ghost bat



Length 4–4¼ in (10–12 cm)
Tail None
Weight 2½–5 oz (75–150 g)
Social unit Group
Status Vulnerable

Location W. and N. Australia



This species is also known as the Australian false vampire bat after the mistaken belief that it feeds on blood. One of the largest microchiropterans, it preys on insects, birds, lizards, and other bats. Its decline may be partly due to the increasing use of its rocky roosting sites for mines and quarries.

Thyroptera tricolor

Spix's disk-winged bat



Length 1½ in (4 cm)
Tail 1–1½ in (2.5–3.5 cm)
Weight ⅓–⅔ oz (3–5 g)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location Mexico to Central America, South America, Trinidad



The disk-winged or sucker-footed bat has a rounded, suckerlike structure near each thumb claw in the middle front edge of the wing, and a smaller one on the sole of each foot. Like tiny suction cups, these grip smooth, glossy leaf surfaces so that the bat can shelter within partly furled leaves—roosting head up, unlike nearly all other bats. The grip of a single sucker is sufficient to bear the bat's weight, which averages 0.14 oz (4 g). Alternatively, it rests with others of its kind in small groups of up to 10, among unfurled leaves. Spix's disk-winged bat is the smallest of 5 New World disk-winged species, and feeds on small creatures, many of them nonflying, such as jumping spiders. It is slim and delicate, with a dark or reddish brown back and whitish brown or yellow underparts. Females are slightly larger than the males.

Rhinopoma hardwickei

Lesser mouse-tailed bat

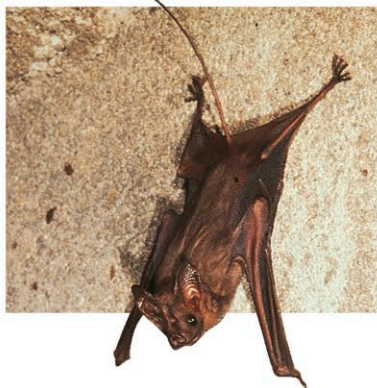


Length 2½–2¾ in (5.5–7 cm)
Tail 1¾–3 in (4.5–7.5 cm)
Weight ⅓–⅔ oz (10–15 g)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location W. to S. Asia, N. and E. Africa



Also called long-tailed bats, the 4–6 *Rhinopoma* species are the world's only small, insectivorous bats with thin, trailing tails. The tail may be as long as both head and body. This species lives in scrub, semidesert, and tropical forest. When food is plentiful, it may double its body weight, storing fat for several weeks of dry-season inactivity.



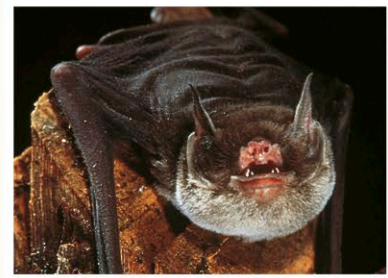
Pteronotus davyi

Davy's naked-backed bat



Length 1½–2½ in (4–5.5 cm)
Tail ¾–1 in (2–2.5 cm)
Weight ⅓–⅔ oz (5–10 g)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location Mexico to N. and E. South America



This bat is a common sight at night near towns, as it feeds on flies, moths, and other insects attracted to streetlights. By day, it roosts in large colonies in caves and old mines, often some distance away from its feeding areas. Davy's naked-backed bat has wings that join along the center of the back, obscuring the fur beneath. Bats within this genus are also known as moustached or leaf-lipped bats.

Rhinolophus hipposideros

Lesser horseshoe bat



Length 1½ in (4 cm)
Tail ¾–1½ in (2–3.5 cm)
Weight ⅓–⅔ oz (4–10 g)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location Europe, N. Africa to W. Asia



Hipposideros speoris

Schneider's leaf-nosed bat



Length 1¾–2½ in (4.5–6 cm)
Tail ¾–1½ in (2–3 cm)
Weight ⅓–⅔ oz (9–12 g)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location S. Asia



A medium-sized member of this genus of at least 70 species, this bat is a typical, small insect-eater. It has a flaplike "leaf" on the upper muzzle around the nostrils, with a U-shaped part below. By day, thousands roost in caves, tunnels, and buildings.

This diminutive bat is widespread in woods and scrub. Despite being classified as least concern, the species is at risk. Its underground, winter hibernation sites, such as deep caverns, have been disturbed, as have summer day roosts in tree holes, caves, chimneys, and mine shafts. Domestic cats take a heavy toll and destruction of woods and hedges has reduced the availability of its prey of small flying insects. The lesser horseshoe is one of the smallest of the 80 species of horseshoe bats.

Nycteris grandis

Large slit-faced bat



Length 2¾–3¾ in (7–9.5 cm)
Tail 2½–3 in (6.5–7.5 cm)
Weight ⅔–1⅓ oz (25–40 g)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location W., C., E., and southern Africa



This slit-faced bat has a furrow down the face. This may be partly covered by nose "leaves," so it looks like 2 slits running from nostrils to eyes. A powerful species, it swoops onto other bats, birds, scorpions, sunspiders, frogs, and even fish near the surface. By day, it roosts in groups of up to 60 in trees, caves, and buildings.

Noctilio leporinus

Greater bulldog bat



Length 2½–3 in (6–8 cm)
Tail ½–¾ in (1.5–2 cm)
Weight ⅓–⅔ oz (15–35 g)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location Central America, N., E., and C. South America

Also called fisherman bats, the two species of bulldog bats have large nose pads, drooping upper lips, and ridged chins. The greater bulldog bat has velvety fur—orange, brown, or gray—with a distinctive pale stripe



along the middle of the back. It roosts by day in hollow trees or caves. At night, it hunts over water or sandy beaches for fish, crabs, and other prey, which it snatches from the ground or water using its large and powerful, sharp-clawed back feet.